DA test plan

Your testing

Start when you're ready to begin the first unfinished step. Overall test time: **00:00:00**

Your name

GitHub name (optional)

DA version tested

2026.10.38

Began testing

yyyy-mm-dd

Finished testing

yyyy-mm-dd

0 / 259 steps done

0 passed, 0 skipped, 0 failed, 259 to go

▶ Earlier test runs

Thank you for testing DA. This plan walks through everything DA does, step by step: first with the **menu** (what most people use), then with **commands typed in a terminal** (for things the menu doesn't have). Each step says what to do and what you should see. Mark it **passed** when it works, **skipped** when you can't try it, and **failed** when it doesn't: write down the step's number (like **D7**) and what happened, and see Reporting a problem.

On the website this page keeps track for you: fill in your name at the top (and the version, which is filled in already), then mark each step with its buttons: ✓ **passed** (green), ○ **skipped** (yellow) or ✗ **failed** (red); press it again to clear it. The page counts your progress and remembers it - in this browser, on this computer only. Each step's **Report** button opens a new problem report with the step, your name and the version already filled in, and marks the step failed. Problems already reported for a step (by you or anyone) are listed under it, with whether they're still open and their labels. **Save as PDF** keeps a dated copy of your results; when a new version of DA comes out, **Start again on a new version** clears them for the next round. On paper, use the printable checklist.

The website has one **Start timing** button. When you're ready, start it; the first unfinished step is timed. Choose that step's passed, skipped or failed result to save its time and automatically move timing to the next unfinished step. Use **Pause timing** for breaks; resume when you're ready. Each section's time is the sum of its steps, and the overall time is the sum of all section times. Timing is saved in this browser along with your results; starting again on a new version clears it.

You don't need to do it all in one sitting: each part starts from where the one before left off. The whole plan takes a few evenings. The user guide explains anything this plan mentions; the known problems list what's already known, so you don't need to report those.

Before you start

- **Use copies, never your only photos.** DA never deletes anything and asks before it moves anything, but this is a test: copy some photos into a new folder and test with those.
- **A Windows PC** with about 5 GB free, and an internet connection for a few steps (places, updates).
- **Write down your DA version** (it's shown in step A5) when you report anything.
- Words used here: an **archive** is the folder DA looks after; **intake** is where you put new files; a **sidecar** is the small `.meta.json` file DA keeps beside each photo; the **menu** is what opens when you double-click an archive's `Open DA.cmd` (or type `da`).

Make a test kit

Make a folder `C:\DA-test-kit` and put copies of these in it. The more kinds you have, the more of the plan you can try; skip a step whose files you don't have and mark it **skipped**.

Folder in the kit	What to put in it	Used in
`phone`	20-50 photos from a phone (JPG or HEIC), some taken outdoors (they have a location)	C, H, K, L
`phone`	2-3 iPhone **Live Photos** (each is a `.HEIC` or `.JPG` plus a `.MOV` with the same name)	I
`phone`	2-3 ordinary videos (`.mov` or `.mp4`, longer than 5 seconds)	I
`camera`	5-10 photos from a different camera (another phone, or a digital camera)	H, K
`scans`	5 scans of old prints (JPG/PNG/TIFF that have **no date** in them or in their name)	G, J
`docs`	3-5 PDFs (bills, letters) and a Word or Excel file	G
`doubles`	3 photos that are **exact copies** of photos in `phone` (copy them again)	F
`old`	3-5 photos taken in a different decade from the rest (say 2005 if the rest are 2020s)	M
`other`	an old camera video (`.AVI` / `.MPG`), a `.CR2` / `.NEF` raw file with its JPG, a screenshot	D, I

A. Install DA · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 21

#	Do this	You should see	Result
A1	Open https://da.gamenightbymike.com	The DA User Guide, with a **Download DA** button and a contents list on the left	Time: 00:00:00
A2	Click **Download DA**	`DA.exe` downloads (about 75 MB); if the browser asks, choose **Keep**	Time: 00:00:00
A3	In File Explorer, go to Downloads, click the address bar, type `powershell`, press Enter	A blue/black terminal window opens in Downloads	Time: 00:00:00
A4	Type `.\DA.exe install` and press Enter	"Installed C:\Scripts\DA\DA.exe and added it to your PATH" (or "already on your PATH")	Time: 00:00:00
A4a	If instead you see "*an application control policy has blocked this file*" or a Windows Security warning that won't go away	Go to step **A10** (install with Python) and skip A5-A9	Time: 00:00:00
A4b	If you see "*Windows protected your PC*"	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**; then A4 works	Time: 00:00:00
A4c	At the end of A4, read the *Long paths* line	*Long paths: on*, or *Long paths are off* and *Turn long paths on now?*: answer **y**, click **Yes** in Windows' permission window; it says *Long paths: on*	Time: 00:00:00
A4d	In File Explorer, right-click `C:\Scripts\DA\DA.exe`, **Properties**, **Details**	*File version* and *Product version* show the same version as `da version` (not 0.0.0.0)	Time: 00:00:00
A5	Close the terminal, open a **new** one (Windows key, type `powershell`, Enter), type `da version`	`DA v2026.10.…` - write this version down	Time: 00:00:00
A6	Type `da --help`	A list of commands (setup, run, status, archives, guide, ...)	Time: 00:00:00
A7	Type `da guide`	The user guide opens in your browser	Time: 00:00:00
A8	Type `da guide --pdf`	The guide's PDF opens	Time: 00:00:00
A9	Type `da update`	It says which version you have and how to get the newest DA.exe	Time: 00:00:00
A10	*(Python install - only if Windows blocks DA.exe, or to test it)* Follow the guide's Install DA with Python: install Python from python.org	`py --version` in a new terminal shows `Python 3.…`	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
A11	Type the guide's first line: `py -m venv C:\Scripts\DA\python`	No error; the folder `C:\Scripts\DA\python` exists	Time: 00:00:00
A12	Type the second line (`…python.exe -m pip install -r https://da.gamenightbymike.com/python/requirements.txt`)	It downloads and ends with "Successfully installed … devmukmuk-da-…"	Time: 00:00:00
A13	Type the third line (`…python.exe -m mindit install`)	"Installed C:\Scripts\DA\da.cmd (DA run by Python …)"; if a DA.exe was there: "Set aside DA.exe (now DA.exe.off)"	Time: 00:00:00
A14	New terminal: `da version`	The version, with **no** Windows Security pop-up	Time: 00:00:00
A15	`da update`	"Downloading the newest DA …" then "Now: DA v…"	Time: 00:00:00
A16	Outside any archive, type `da status`	"Not inside an archive" and how to open one (no crash)	Time: 00:00:00
A17	Type `da` on its own (outside any archive)	"You're not inside an archive" and an offer to create one (answer **n** for now)	Time: 00:00:00

B. Create an archive · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 20

#	Do this	You should see	Result
B1	In a terminal: `da setup C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x --years 2020-2029`	"Archive ready" and the folder's path	Time: 00:00:00
B2	Open `C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` in File Explorer	`da-archive.yaml`, `Open DA.cmd`, and folders `intake` (with `photos`, `docs`, `scans`), `photos`, `documents`, `output`, `logs`	Time: 00:00:00
B3	Open `da-archive.yaml` in Notepad (right-click, Open with, Notepad), then close it	`name: "jane-archive-202x"`, `years: "2020-2029"`, the intake folders, `contact_sheets: layout: 3x4`	Time: 00:00:00
B4	Double-click `Open DA.cmd`	A window opens: a box with the archive's name, folder and years, then the **Status** (intake: 0 files), then the menu keys	Time: 00:00:00
B5	Look at the menu	Keys **1-7**, **L**, **S**, **M**, **R**, **D**, **J**, **U**, **H**, **Q**	Time: 00:00:00
B6	Press **H**, Enter	A short "How DA works" help, and a list of commands	Time: 00:00:00
B7	Press **U**, Enter	The user guide opens in the browser	Time: 00:00:00
B8	Press **x** (not a menu key), Enter	"Pick one of the numbers or letters shown." and the menu again	Time: 00:00:00
B9	Press **Q**, Enter	The menu closes; the window stays open with a line saying you can type `da` for the menu	Time: 00:00:00
B10	Type `da` in that window	The menu again, starting with the Status	Time: 00:00:00
B11	Press **7** (New archive), Enter	"Archives on this PC already:" with `jane-archive-202x … <- open now`, then a question for a new folder	Time: 00:00:00
B12	Type `C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x`, Enter; years `2000-2009`, Enter	"Archive ready", and the menu now shows **sam-archive-200x** with its Status	Time: 00:00:00
B13	Press **6** (Switch archive), Enter	Both archives listed with their years; type the number of **jane-archive-202x**	Time: 00:00:00
B14		The menu shows jane-archive-202x again, with its Status	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
B15	Press Q. In the same window type `da archives`	A table of this PC's archives (name, years, folder)	Time: 00:00:00
B16	`da archives --open 2`	The second archive's menu opens (press Q to leave)	Time: 00:00:00
B17	`da setup C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x --years 2000-2009` again	It says the archive is already there and keeps its settings (nothing moved)	Time: 00:00:00
B18	Make a folder `C:\DA-test\filled`, copy 3 kit photos into it, then `da setup C:\DA-test\filled`	It lists what's in the folder and asks before moving those into `intake\`; answer **n**	Time: 00:00:00
B19	Run it again and answer **y**	The 3 photos are now in `C:\DA-test\filled\intake\`, and the archive's files appear	Time: 00:00:00
B20	`da setup C:\DA-test\bad --years 1999-1990`	A clear message that years must look like 1990-1999 (nothing made)	Time: 00:00:00

C. The first run: process intake (menu 1) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 20

Copy the whole test kit (except `old`) into `jane-archive-202x\intake\photos\kit` (so `kit\phone`, `kit\camera`, … are inside), copy `scans` into `intake\scans`, and `docs` into `intake\docs`.

#	Do this	You should see	Result
C1	Open jane-archive-202x (its `Open DA.cmd`)	The Status shows the intake files, folder by folder, with counts	Time: 00:00:00
C2	Press **1** (Process intake)	"Counting what's in intake …", then a list of intake's folders with file counts	Time: 00:00:00
C3	Type the number of `photos` to open it	Its subfolders (`kit`) are listed; you can open further, go up, or filter by name	Time: 00:00:00
C4	Type part of a name (for example `kit`) to filter	Only matching folders are listed	Time: 00:00:00
C5	Go back up to the top of intake and choose to process **all of intake**	"Processing … DA asks before moving anything"	Time: 00:00:00
C6	Watch step **1/7 Indexing**	A count of files indexed, no error	Time: 00:00:00
C7	Step **2/7 Hashing**	A progress count, then a summary	Time: 00:00:00
C8	Step **3/7** (duplicates): it asks whether to set exact copies aside; answer **y**	The 3 `doubles` are listed and moved to `_duplicates-holding` (see F)	Time: 00:00:00
C9	Step **4/7 Preview**	"planning names and folders (nothing moves)" and a plan: how many files to file, how many need review	Time: 00:00:00
C10	Step **5/7 Plan/check**	Numbers of files to file, raw files and Live Photo videos going with them, and problems to review	Time: 00:00:00
C11	It asks whether to file them; answer **n**	It stops; nothing was moved; the run is recorded in `output\runs\`	Time: 00:00:00
C12	Press **1** again and process all of intake again; answer **y** to each question	Steps 1-7 run; "Filed N; hash ok N; problems: 0" and "Done. Run record: …"	Time: 00:00:00
C13		Right after, "Where things stand now:" and the Status (fewer files waiting)	Time: 00:00:00
C14	In File Explorer open `photos\organized`	Year folders (`2021`, …) with month folders (`2021-06`, …)	Time: 00:00:00
C15	Open a month folder	Files named `photo_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.jpg` (or `.heic`) in date order, each with a `.meta.json` beside it, and a `_contact-sheet.pdf`	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
C16	Check one photo's name against when it was taken (its date in the Photos app)	The date and time in the name match	Time: 00:00:00
C17	Open one `.meta.json` in Notepad	A text file with `"schema": {"name": "mindit.sidecar", "version": 2}`, a `file` block with its sha256, and a `camera` block	Time: 00:00:00
C18	Look in `intake\photos\kit`	Only files that need you are left (no date, other decade, ...)	Time: 00:00:00
C19	Back in the menu, press **2** (Status)	Organized photos/documents counts and the last run's time and "filed N"	Time: 00:00:00
C20	Process intake a third time	"Nothing to file" (or only the review ones are planned) - nothing is filed twice	Time: 00:00:00

D. What needs review (menu 3) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 8

#	Do this	You should see	Result
D1	Press **3**	Groups of what the last run left, each with a reason and up to 5 examples	Time: 00:00:00
D2		**No date (in the file or its name)**: your scans of prints and any undated files	Time: 00:00:00
D3		If you included a photo from another decade in `kit`: **Taken outside this archive's years**	Time: 00:00:00
D4		"Full list: ...\review.csv"	Time: 00:00:00
D5	Open that `review.csv` (double-click; it opens in Excel or Notepad)	One row per file: reason, file, detail	Time: 00:00:00
D6	The screenshot from `other`	Filed by a date in its name, or listed under No date - not a crash	Time: 00:00:00
D7	The raw file (`.CR2` / `.NEF`)	Moved and renamed together with its JPG (same new name, raw extension), not left alone	Time: 00:00:00
D8	A raw file whose JPG isn't there	Left in intake	Time: 00:00:00

E. Status and the index (menu 2, 5) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 9

#	Do this	You should see	Result
E1	Press **2**	The same numbers as the box at the top, plus intake folder by folder	Time: 00:00:00
E2	In File Explorer, move one filed photo (and its `.meta.json`) to your Desktop		Time: 00:00:00
E3	Press **5** (Refresh index)	It indexes, then the counts drop by one	Time: 00:00:00
E4	Move the photo back where it was, press **5**	Counts back up	Time: 00:00:00
E5	Terminal (in the archive): `da db stats`	Counts by year and kind	Time: 00:00:00
E6	`da db query "SELECT file_name, captured_at FROM files WHERE area = 'photos' LIMIT 5"`	Five photos with their dates	Time: 00:00:00
E7	`da db query "DELETE FROM files"`	Refused: only SELECT is allowed (nothing deleted)	Time: 00:00:00
E8	`da status`	The same Status as menu 2	Time: 00:00:00
E9	`da intake status`	Intake folder by folder: files, GB, photos, raw, documents, videos, hashed, already in organized	Time: 00:00:00

F. Duplicates and undo (menu 4) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 7

#	Do this	You should see	Result
F1	Open `_duplicates-holding` in the archive	Today's date folder with the 3 `doubles` (exact copies), and a `moved.csv` record	Time: 00:00:00
F2	Press **4** (Undo last set-aside)	"Put 3 files back where they were (from ...)?"; answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00
F3		"Restored 3"; the doubles are back in `intake\photos\kit\doubles`	Time: 00:00:00
F4	Process intake again (menu 1, answer y)	The doubles are set aside again (they're still exact copies of filed photos)	Time: 00:00:00
F5	Press **4** and answer **n**	Nothing changes	Time: 00:00:00
F6	Delete the folder in `_duplicates-holding` yourself (they're copies)	Fine: DA doesn't need them	Time: 00:00:00
F7	*(Optional, long paths off: skip it if A4c turned them on)* Put a copy of a kit photo in intake inside folders nested deep enough that its path is about 240 characters, and process intake	The step carries on; *Not moved ... path too long for Windows* for that copy, which stays in intake	Time: 00:00:00

G. Documents and scans · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 5

#	Do this	You should see	Result
G1	Open `documents\organized`	Year/month folders with `doc_YYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.pdf` (and your Word/Excel file)	Time: 00:00:00
G2	Compare a PDF's folder with the date it was created (File, Properties in a PDF reader)	It's filed by the date inside the PDF	Time: 00:00:00
G3	The scans you put in `intake\scans`	Treated as **documents**, not photos; scans with no date wait under No date	Time: 00:00:00
G4	A PDF with flaws (an old scanner's PDF, if you have one)	Processed without a stream of red/yellow warnings on the screen	Time: 00:00:00
G5	Put a `.jpg` scan of a letter in `intake\docs` and process	It's filed under `documents`, not `photos`	Time: 00:00:00

H. Contact sheets · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 14

#	Do this	You should see	Result
H1	Double-click a month's `_contact-sheet.pdf`	Page 1 is a **summary**: folder name, photo/video counts, the days, GPS count, places, sidecar versions, and a **Cameras** table with page numbers	Time: 00:00:00
H2	Page 2 onwards	A section per camera: each page headed `<month> - <camera> / <owner>` (or just the camera)	Time: 00:00:00
H3		12 pictures a page (3 across, 4 down), each with its name and date underneath	Time: 00:00:00
H4	A photo taken outdoors with a phone	**GPS** in green down its left edge	Time: 00:00:00
H5	Every picture	A small circled **2** at its top right (the sidecar version)	Time: 00:00:00
H6	A video	A dark **VIDEO** tile with its length	Time: 00:00:00
H7	A Live Photo	Shown once (its photo), not twice	Time: 00:00:00
H8	Terminal: `da contact-sheets photos\organized --layout 4x5`	"Made or updated N"; that sheet now has 20 pictures a page	Time: 00:00:00
H9	`da contact-sheets photos\organized` (no layout)	Sheets go back to 3x4	Time: 00:00:00
H10	`da contact-sheets photos\organized --layout 9x9`	A clear message: a layout looks like 3x4 or 4x5	Time: 00:00:00
H11	Run H9 again	"already up to date N" (nothing made again)	Time: 00:00:00
H12	Copy one more photo into a month folder (with no sidecar) and run `da validate <that month folder>`	Its contact sheet is made again and includes the new photo	Time: 00:00:00
H13	`da contact-sheets photos\organized --force`	Every sheet made again	Time: 00:00:00
H14	In `da-archive.yaml` set `contact_sheets:` `layout: 4x5`, save, run H9	Sheets now 20 a page; set it back to `3x4` afterwards	Time: 00:00:00

I. Videos, Live Photos and HEIC · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 10

#	Do this	You should see	Result
I1	Your ordinary videos	Filed in their month as `video_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.mov` (or `.mp4`) beside the photos	Time: 00:00:00
I2	Open a video's `.meta.json`	A `video` block with `duration_seconds` and `recorded_at`; `classification` says `video`	Time: 00:00:00
I3	A Live Photo (HEIC + MOV with the same name)	Both filed together: `photo_…_xxxx.heic` and `photo_…_xxxx.mov` (same name)	Time: 00:00:00
I4	Copy a Live Photo's `.MOV` alone (without its photo) into intake, process	It stays in intake (it's the short video of a Live Photo)	Time: 00:00:00
I5	Terminal: `da pair-movies`	It finds that video's filed photo and lists where it would go; nothing moves	Time: 00:00:00
I6	`da pair-movies --apply`	"Moved 1" and an Undo line; the video is now beside its photo with the same name	Time: 00:00:00
I7	`da intake undo "<the file it names>"`	The video goes back to intake	Time: 00:00:00
I8	An old camera `.AVI` / `.MPG`	Filed by the date inside it, or listed under No date (then see J)	Time: 00:00:00
I9	`da heic-to-jpg photos\organized\<year>\<month>`	JPG copies of the HEIC photos made in a folder beside it (the HEICs stay)	Time: 00:00:00
I10	`da heic-to-jpg <a folder> --out C:\DA-test\jpgs`	The copies go to `C:\DA-test\jpgs`	Time: 00:00:00

J. Fix dates (menu D) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 18

#	Do this	You should see	Result
J1	Press **D**	Each intake folder with undated photos, one at a time, with a count and an example name	Time: 00:00:00
J2	For the scans folder type `1998-07`, Enter	(B1's archive takes 2020-2029, so these will wait as "outside this archive's years" - that's expected)	Time: 00:00:00
J3	For another folder type `July`, Enter	"'July' isn't a date DA reads. Use 1998, 1998-07, ..." and it asks again	Time: 00:00:00
J4	Type `2021-06-15`, Enter	Accepted	Time: 00:00:00
J5	Press Enter on a folder	That folder is skipped	Time: 00:00:00
J6		"Dates set on N files." and "Process intake now?"; answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00
J7		The folder dated 2021-06-15 is filed as `photo_20210615_000000_xxxx` in `2021\2021-06`	Time: 00:00:00
J8	Terminal: `da date list`	Photos still without a sure date, folder by folder (or "Every photo ... has a sure date")	Time: 00:00:00
J9	`da date set "<a scan>" --date 2022`	"Only a year: DA files them under 2022-01 (January)...", "Date set to 2022 on 1 file"	Time: 00:00:00
J10	`da date set "<a scan>" --date "2022-03-04 14:30"`	Date set; after processing, named `photo_20220304_143000_...`	Time: 00:00:00
J11	`da date set "<a scan>" --date 2022-13`	A clear message: not a real date	Time: 00:00:00
J12	`da date clear "<that scan>"`	"Dates set by hand taken off on 1 file"	Time: 00:00:00
J13	Pick a **filed** photo; `da date shift "<it>" --by +1h`	"Dates shifted +1h on 1 file" and a `da validate ... --mode repair` line	Time: 00:00:00
J14	Run that `da validate ... --mode repair` line	The photo is renamed one hour later (and moved if the month changed)	Time: 00:00:00
J15	`da date shift "<it>" --by -1h` and repair again	Back to its original name	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
J16	`da date shift <folder> --by +2d` / `-30m` / `+1mo` / `-1y`	Each accepted (try one, then shift back)	Time: 00:00:00
J17	`da date shift <folder> --by 1h` (no sign)	A clear message: use +1h, -30m, …	Time: 00:00:00
J18	Shift a folder that includes an undated scan	The undated one is listed as skipped: "no sure date to shift"	Time: 00:00:00

K. Tags (terminal) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 38

#	Do this	You should see	Result
K1	In the archive: `da tag`	"Read camera details and make automatic tags for N photos in ...?"; answer **y**; "Tagged N photos"	Time: 00:00:00
K2	Open a filed photo's `.meta.json`	`auto_tags` with tags like `maker:apple`, `camera:apple-iphone-…`, `year:2021`, and `gps` for outdoor photos	Time: 00:00:00
K3	`da tag --cameras`	A table of the cameras found, with photo counts and years; it asks who used each (type a name like `jane`, or Enter to skip)	Time: 00:00:00
K4		"saved: Use camera	Time: 00:00:00
K5	`da tag --owner "<a camera from K3>" sam`	"saved: ... -> sam" and "Update the owner: tags now?"	Time: 00:00:00
K6	`da tag photos\organized\<year>\<month> beach`	"Your tags on N files: +beach"	Time: 00:00:00
K7	`da tag photos\organized\<year>\<month> -x beach`	"-beach"	Time: 00:00:00
K8	`da tag "<one photo>" grandma "summer trip"`	Tags `grandma` and `summer-trip` added to that photo	Time: 00:00:00
K9	`da findit tags photos\organized -r grandma -v`	`"match_count": 1` and that photo	Time: 00:00:00
K10	`da findit tags photos\organized -r gps -v`	The photos with a location	Time: 00:00:00
K11	`da findit tags photos\organized -x gps -v`	The photos without	Time: 00:00:00
K12	`da findit tags photos\organized -r owner:jane -v`	Photos from the camera you named in K3	Time: 00:00:00
K13	`da tag --refresh` (answer y)	Camera details read again from every photo; tags unchanged	Time: 00:00:00
K14	Open a contact sheet made after K3 (run `da contact-sheets <month>`)	The camera sections now show **/ jane**	Time: 00:00:00
K15	Copy 2-3 screenshots or photos of receipts into `intake\phone` and choose **1 Process intake**	They're filed under `photos\organized`	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
K16	`da tag ocr photos\organised` (a typo)	*No such folder or file*; nothing is tagged	Time: 00:00:00
K17	`da tag ocr photos\organized\<their year>`	A preview: how many are mostly text (document), with some text, without; *Nothing changed*; the path of `ocr-results.csv`	Time: 00:00:00
K18	Open that `ocr-results.csv` in Excel	One row per picture: level, words, *would tag and move* for the screenshots, and the start of their text	Time: 00:00:00
K19	`da tag ocr photos\organized\<their year> --tag-only`	*read now: 0* (the preview's reading is reused); *Tagged N pictures*	Time: 00:00:00
K20	Open a screenshot's `.meta.json`	An `ocr` block with its text, and `text`, `document` in `auto_tags`	Time: 00:00:00
K21	`da tag ocr photos\organized\<their year> --tag-and-move`	It asks *Move N document pictures?*; answer **y**: they're in `documents\organized\<year>\<year-month>` with `doc_` names, with sidecars	Time: 00:00:00
K22	`da intake undo "<the ocr-moved.csv it printed>"`	They're back in `photos\organized`, with their old names	Time: 00:00:00
K23	`da rename`	*0 would be renamed, N already named so*; *Nothing changed*; the path of `rename-plan.csv`	Time: 00:00:00
K24	`da rename photos\organized\<their year> --pattern "{YYYY}{MM}{DD}_{camera}_{owner}_{hash:4}"`	How many *would be renamed*, raw files following them, and *had nothing for {owner}* for photos with no known owner; the files keep their names	Time: 00:00:00
K25	Open that `rename-plan.csv` in Excel	One row per file: its path, the new name, *rename* / *follows* / *unchanged*, and notes like *the name token {owner} was missing*	Time: 00:00:00
K26	`da rename intake`	*use da run*; nothing is planned	Time: 00:00:00
K27	In the menu press **N**	The photo, video and document patterns, and how to try one	Time: 00:00:00
K28	Type **1**, then the pattern `{YYYY}-{MM}-{DD}_{hh}{mm}_{hash:4}`	How many *would be renamed*; *Rename N files?* - answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00
K29		*Renamed N*, and an *Undo: da intake undo ...* line; then *Save it in da-archive.yaml?* - answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
K30	Open a month folder and `da-archive.yaml`	Photos named like `2024-07-04_1015_ab12.jpg` (raw files too, sidecars beside them); in the file, the new pattern and `# was (<today>): photo_...` under it	Time: 00:00:00
K31	Press **N** again, then **Enter**	*0 would be renamed*	Time: 00:00:00
K32	`da intake undo "<the rename-moved.csv it printed>"`	The old names are back; **N**, **Enter** now offers to rename them again (the saved pattern stays until you change it)	Time: 00:00:00
K33	Press **N**, **1**, type the old pattern (`photo_{date_taken:%Y%m%d_%H%M%S}_{hash:4}`), answer **y** twice	Back as before; `da-archive.yaml` keeps both earlier patterns as notes, newest first	Time: 00:00:00
K34	`da rename --folder "{owner}\{YYYY}"`	*N moved to another folder, had nothing for {owner}* for photos with no known owner; nothing moves	Time: 00:00:00
K35	`da rename --folder "{owner}\{YYYY}" --kind photo --apply --save` and answer **y** twice	Photos of cameras with an owner are in `photos\organized\<owner>\<year>` , the others in `photos\organized\<year>` ; the emptied month folders are gone; each folder has a contact sheet	Time: 00:00:00
K36	Copy a new photo into intake and choose **1 Process intake**	It's filed by the new folder pattern	Time: 00:00:00
K37	`da intake undo "<the rename-moved.csv it printed>"` , then **N**, **1**, Enter, type `{YYYY}\{YYYY}-{MM}` , answer **y** twice	Back in year and month folders; `da-archive.yaml` keeps `# folder was (...)` notes	Time: 00:00:00
K38	*(Optional: do it between K35 and K37, while the photos are in the owner layout)* `da location group <a month with GPS photos, e.g. 2024-07>` and give group 1 a title	The month's photos are found in `<owner>\<year>` ; the location folder is made there (`<owner>\<year>\<year-month> <title> (<place>)`)	Time: 00:00:00

L. Places and location folders (menu L) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 21

These need an internet connection, except L12.

#	Do this	You should see	Result
L1	Terminal: `da location lookup`	How many photos have a GPS position, how many new places, "about one a second", a privacy note; "Start?"	Time: 00:00:00
L2	Answer **y**	A progress count, then "N of N GPS photos have a place" and a list like `place:springfield-il 24`	Time: 00:00:00
L3	Run it again	"0 new spots"; it finishes at once (places are remembered)	Time: 00:00:00
L4	`da findit tags photos\organized -r place:<one of the places> -v`	Those photos	Time: 00:00:00
L5	`da db query "SELECT city, COUNT(*) FROM files GROUP BY city"`	Towns with counts	Time: 00:00:00
L6	In the menu press **L**	"Months with GPS photos (newest first):" numbered	Time: 00:00:00
L7	Type a month's number	Groups of photos taken close together: count, days and times, places, first file	Time: 00:00:00
L8	For group 1 type a title like `Beach day`; press Enter for the others	"DA will: make 2021-06 Beach day () (N photos)" and "Move them?"	Time: 00:00:00
L9	Answer **y**	"Moved N photos into 1 folder; … contact sheets made" and an **Undo** line	Time: 00:00:00
L10	Open the year folder	`2021-06 Beach day (<place>)` beside `2021-06`, with its own contact sheet; photos without GPS stayed in `2021-06`	Time: 00:00:00
L11	`da validate "photos\organized\2021\2021-06 Beach day (<place>)"`	"Problems found: 0" (a location folder is a proper home)	Time: 00:00:00
L12	`da location rename "<that folder>" "Beach with grandma"`	The new name, "Rename it?", then "Renamed; title set on N sidecars" and an Undo line	Time: 00:00:00
L13	`da location set "<a photo without GPS>" --place "Springfield, IL"`	"Found: Springfield, …", asks, "Done: 1 photo"	Time: 00:00:00
L14	`da location set "<another photo>" --same-as "<a GPS photo>"`	"Done: 1 photo" (no lookup)	Time: 00:00:00
L15	`da location set "<that photo>" --clear`	"Done: 1 photo"	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
L16	Group that month again with **L**	A group taken at the same time and place says "fits the folder already there"; Enter adds to it	Time: 00:00:00
L17	`da location group photos\organized\<year>\<month> --hours 1 --km 0.5`	Smaller groups; answer **n** / press Enter to move nothing	Time: 00:00:00
L18	`da intake undo "<the file L9 named>"`	The photos go back to `2021-06` ; the location folder is gone	Time: 00:00:00
L19	`da location lookup --offline`	Uses only remembered places; nothing sent	Time: 00:00:00
L20	In `da-archive.yaml` set `location:` `lookup: off` , run `da location lookup`	"Lookups are off in da-archive.yaml ..."; set it back afterwards	Time: 00:00:00
L21	`da location group C:\DA-test` (not a month folder)	A clear message that it isn't a month folder	Time: 00:00:00

M. Split by years (menu S) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 9

Copy the kit's `old` photos (another decade) into jane-archive-202x's `intake\photos\old` , process intake (they stay: outside this archive's years). sam-archive-200x (from B12) takes 2000-2009.

#	Do this	You should see	Result
M1	In jane-archive-202x press **S**	"Working out the dates …", "N files in intake were taken outside 2020-2029", and which archive each belongs in	Time: 00:00:00
M2		"Move them to:" with sam-archive-200x listed; choose it	Time: 00:00:00
M3		What will move (from → to) and "Move them?"; answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00
M4		"Moved N files", an Undo line, and "Next: open sam-archive-200x … 1 Process intake"	Time: 00:00:00
M5	Open sam-archive-200x's `intake\photos\from-jane-archive-202x`	The old photos (and their sidecars)	Time: 00:00:00
M6	In sam-archive-200x, process intake	They're filed in `2000s` year folders	Time: 00:00:00
M7	Terminal (jane-archive-202x): `da split`	"0 files in intake were taken outside 2020-2029"	Time: 00:00:00
M8	Undo instead (repeat M1-M4 with new old photos, then `da intake undo "<the file M4 named>"`)	They're back in jane's intake (works even across drives)	Time: 00:00:00
M9	A decade with no archive yet	"N from the 1990s have no archive on this PC yet. Make one: da setup --years 1990-1999"	Time: 00:00:00

N. Merge two copies (menu M) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 8

Copy the whole `C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` folder to `C:\DA-test\jane-copy` . Add 3 new photos to jane-copy's intake and process them **in jane-copy** (open its `Open DA.cmd`).

#	Do this	You should see	Result
N1	In **jane-archive-202x** press **M**	This PC's other archives listed; choose jane-copy (or type its folder)	Time: 00:00:00
N2		"Indexing …", "Comparing …", "N files in jane-copy: M already here" and what would be copied (3 to the same folder and name here)	Time: 00:00:00
N3		"Copy them?"; answer **y**	Time: 00:00:00
N4		"Copied 3 files: 3 filed …" and an Undo line; the 3 photos are in jane-archive-202x's month folders	Time: 00:00:00
N5	Look in jane-copy	Unchanged (merge only copies from it)	Time: 00:00:00
N6	Press **M** again, choose jane-copy	"Nothing to copy"	Time: 00:00:00
N7	`da intake undo "<the file N4 named>"`	The 3 copies are removed from jane-archive-202x	Time: 00:00:00
N8	`da merge --from C:\DA-test\nowhere`	A clear message that it isn't an archive	Time: 00:00:00

O. Report and dashboard (menu R, B) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 16

#	Do this	You should see	Result
O1	Press **R**	A short summary, then the PDF opens	Time: 00:00:00
O2		One page: what's filed (photos, documents, videos, space, years), waiting for you, by year, cameras, places	Time: 00:00:00
O3	Open the archive's `output` folder	`jane-archive-202x-report-YYYY-MM-DD.pdf`	Time: 00:00:00
O4	`da report --refresh`	The index is refreshed first; the same day's PDF is replaced	Time: 00:00:00
O5	`da report --open`	The PDF opens	Time: 00:00:00
O6	Press **B**	The browser opens a page titled *DA - jane-archive-202x*; DA says how to stop it (`da dashboard --stop`) and the menu is back straight away	Time: 00:00:00
O7		**Filed**, **Waiting in intake** (folder by folder), **Needs review**, **Latest runs** and **Activity** match what you've done so far	Time: 00:00:00
O8	Wait a few seconds	**In the archive** fills in: by year, cameras, places (the same numbers as the report)	Time: 00:00:00
O9	Copy a few photos into `intake\photos`, then in another window `da db build`	Within about 10 seconds the page shows the new files waiting; while `da db build` runs, **Happening now** names it	Time: 00:00:00
O10	Press **Recount**	The button greys out, then the numbers are counted again	Time: 00:00:00
O11	Press **B** again	*already running*, with the same address; the same page opens (not a second dashboard)	Time: 00:00:00
O12	Quit the menu and close its window; reload the page	The dashboard still works	Time: 00:00:00
O12a	In a terminal in the archive, `da dashboard --stop`	*Dashboard stopped*; after a few seconds the page says the dashboard stopped	Time: 00:00:00
O12b	`da dashboard --stop` again	*No dashboard is running for this archive*	Time: 00:00:00

#	Do this	You should see	Result
O12c	`da dashboard --foreground --port 9000`	It prints `http://127.0.0.1:9000/` (or the next free port) and the browser opens it; **Ctrl+C** stops it	Time: 00:00:00
O13	From another computer or a phone, try this PC's name or address with that port	It doesn't open: the dashboard is for this PC only	Time: 00:00:00

P. Update sidecars (menu J) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 5

#	Do this	You should see	Result
P1	Press **J**	"N sidecars: N up to date (schema 2), 0 older." (everything DA made is current)	Time: 00:00:00
P2	*(If you have an older DA archive)* run J there	How many are older and what would change, then "Upgrade N sidecars?"	Time: 00:00:00
P3	Answer **y**	"Upgraded N sidecars", the backup folder, and a `--restore` line	Time: 00:00:00
P4	Run the `--restore` line	"Put back N sidecars"	Time: 00:00:00
P5	`da sidecar upgrade photos\organized\<year>`	Only that year is looked at	Time: 00:00:00

Q. Checking what's filed (terminal) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 8

#	Do this	You should see	Result
Q1	`da validate photos\organized`	A summary: files checked, problems found (0 or a few notes), nothing moved	Time: 00:00:00
Q2	Rename a filed photo in Explorer to `test.jpg` (keep its `.meta.json` renamed to match: `test.jpg.meta.json`), then `da validate <its folder>`	A "wrong name" problem for it, nothing moved	Time: 00:00:00
Q3	`da validate <its folder> --mode repair`	It's renamed back to `photo_…`	Time: 00:00:00
Q4	`da validate intake --mode repair`	Refused: repair isn't for intake (use 1 Process intake / `da run`)	Time: 00:00:00
Q5	`da validate C:\DA-test\kit-copy --archive C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` (any folder outside)	It checks that folder using jane's settings	Time: 00:00:00
Q6	`da run intake\photos\kit\camera --yes`	That folder alone is processed, no questions	Time: 00:00:00
Q7	`da check "<the preview report path from a run>"`	A check of that report	Time: 00:00:00
Q8	`da verify "<a repair report path>"`	Every filed file's hash matches its sidecar	Time: 00:00:00

R. Settings (da-archive.yaml) · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 5

Make a copy of `da-archive.yaml` first; put it back at the end.

#	Do this	You should see	Result
R1	Change `years:` to `"2021-2021"`, process a folder with 2022 photos	They wait as "outside this archive's years"	Time: 00:00:00
R2	Add an intake folder: under `intake:` add `phone: photo`, then `da setup <this archive>`	`intake\phone` is created	Time: 00:00:00
R3	Change `photoit:` `pattern:` to `{date_taken:%Y-%m-%d}_{hash:4}` and validate a month with `--mode repair`	Photos renamed like `2021-06-01_ab12.jpg` (change it back and repair again)	Time: 00:00:00
R4	Break the file (delete a `:`), then `da status`	A clear message about da-archive.yaml (no crash)	Time: 00:00:00
R5	Put the copy back, then `da status`	The Status as before	Time: 00:00:00

S. Logs, records and safety · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 5

#	Do this	You should see	Result
S1	Open `logs\da.jsonl` in Notepad	One line per command: "da … started", "… finished in Ns", and lines for what was moved	Time: 00:00:00
S2	Open `output\runs\`	A folder per run (`…-run`, `…-split`, `…-merge`, `…-location-group`, …) with its records	Time: 00:00:00
S3	Start processing a big folder and press **Ctrl+C** during step 2	It stops; run it again and it carries on (nothing half-moved)	Time: 00:00:00
S4	Run `da run --yes` in one window and `da status` in another	Status works while the run is going (don't run two changing commands at once - see the known problems)	Time: 00:00:00
S5	Throughout: did DA ever delete a photo?	No (it only moves, and asks first)	Time: 00:00:00

T. Another PC or a USB drive · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 4

#	Do this	You should see	Result
T1	Copy `C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x` to a USB stick		Time: 00:00:00
T2	On another PC with DA installed (or the same one, from the stick), double-click the stick's `Open DA.cmd`	The menu opens for that archive	Time: 00:00:00
T3	`da archives`	The stick's archive is now on this PC's list	Time: 00:00:00
T4	Unplug the stick, `da archives`	It's left out until it's plugged in again	Time: 00:00:00

U. Messages when something's wrong · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 6

#	Do this	You should see	Result
U1	`da run` in `C:\` (not an archive)	"Not inside an archive ..." and how to open one	Time: 00:00:00
U2	`da tag photos\organized\2099\2099-01` (a folder that doesn't exist)	*(Known problem: it's treated as a tag. See the known problems; undo with `da tag --remove photos-organized-2099-2099-01`.)*	Time: 00:00:00
U3	`da location set <a photo> --place "zzzz nowhere"`	"Nothing found for ..."	Time: 00:00:00
U4	Disconnect the internet, `da location lookup` on new GPS photos	It stops after two tries and says N photos still need a place; run again later	Time: 00:00:00
U5	`da contact-sheets C:\nowhere`	"No such folder"	Time: 00:00:00
U6	`da --help` and `da location --help` outside an archive	Help shows (no "not inside an archive")	Time: 00:00:00

V. Clean up · Time: 00:00:00 0 / 2

#	Do this	You should see	Result
V1	Delete `C:\DA-test` and `C:\DA-test-kit` when you're done	(Your real photos were never touched)	Time: 00:00:00
V2	To remove DA: delete `C:\Scripts\DA`, and remove it from your PATH (Settings, search "environment variables", Path)	`da` is no longer recognised	Time: 00:00:00

Reporting a problem

1. Check the known problems first.
2. On the website, press the step's **Report** button: a new issue opens at GitHub with the step, your name and your version filled in (a free GitHub account is needed). Or open one yourself at https://github.com/devmukmuk/DA/issues, or send it to the person who asked you to test. The panel at the top shows how many of your reports are still open.
3. Include: the step number (**L9**), what you did, what you expected, what happened (a screenshot helps), your DA version (`da version`), and whether DA is the DA.exe or the Python install.
4. If DA printed an error, the archive's `logs\da.jsonl` has the details: copy the last few lines.
5. Leave out anything private: names, photos, and folder paths you'd rather not share.
